

My gadget shopping hacks with a twist

As Diwali approaches, the excitement of new beginnings and the temptation of the latest gadgets fill the air. Our special issue showcases the 100 best gadgets to buy this festive season, helping you navigate the myriad of options. As someone whose job thrives when you splurge on tech, you'd think I'd be urging you to buy everything in sight. But here's a twist: this time, I'm suggesting we all pause and think before we make a purchase. It might seem unusual, but stay with me and you'd know why.

Lookout for fake deals!

In previous years, I've eagerly upgraded my devices during festive sales, enticed by flashy discounts and the allure of new features. However, I've noticed that these "Diwali offers" aren't always the best. For instance, when I was looking to upgrade my microwave oven earlier this year in May, the price offered then was a good 15 per cent lower than the "Diwali dhamaka deal" being advertised now. It seems that sometimes prices are inflated during festive seasons to make discounts appear more attractive. Don't get lured by every discount and check price histories.

Buyback is good

One practical step is to take advantage of buyback or trade-in programs. While it might seem tempting to hold onto old devices, they often lose value the longer they stay unused. For example, I've been sitting on a very old gaming desktop PC, convincing myself that one day I would rebuild it. That day has never arrived, and now the parts are no longer functional. I could have given it to someone who might have used it. Eventually, devices become obsolete, and disposing of them irresponsibly adds to the e-waste problem. Buyback offers provide a convenient and responsible way to dispose of old gadgets. This Diwali, I encourage you to utilise these programs.

Need vs. Want, where do you stand?

It's also worth reassessing whether an upgrade is truly necessary. Festive deals and marketing



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campaigns can create a sense of urgency for the latest models, but perhaps our current devices still meet our needs. Upgrading out of necessity rather than novelty helps reduce unnecessary consumption and the resulting e-waste. By being mindful of our actual requirements, we can make more sustainable choices.

Don't ignore offline

It's also beneficial to compare online and offline prices. I've seen offline retailers not only match the best online offers but also include additional goodies. By shopping around, you might find better deals than simply jumping at the first discount you see. The bottom line is to shop smart: buy what you need, not just what's offered at a seemingly great discount.

Old gadgets deserve a responsible send-off

My drawers are now a collection of gadgets that seemed essential at the time but ended up unused. This accumulation doesn't just clutter my space; it contributes to the growing problem of electronic waste. Old gadgets contain hazardous materials that can harm the environment if not disposed of properly. By hoarding unused devices, we're inadvertently adding to this issue. Another meaningful option is to donate functional gadgets to those who need them. Donating devices can also help bridge the digital divide, offering others access to resources that enhance education and connectivity. Select devices that truly meet your needs and offer longevity. Investing in high-quality gadgets rather than multiple lower-quality items is more economical and environmentally friendly in the long run. Setting a budget and sticking to it can prevent over-spending driven by impulse rather than necessity.

This Diwali, I'm committing to responsible tech consumption. Sharing this journey, I hope to inspire you to reflect on your purchasing decisions during the festive season. Which gadget did you buy this Diwali? Send me your top deal grab and you could be featured as one of Digit's top deal hunters in the next issue! 